

Announcements for April 13/26 2020

Thomas Sunday

The Christian response to Anxiety, emotions, etc.

Asking the saints to help us is biblical and humble.

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-04-26.html>

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-04-26.doc>

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-04-26.pdf>

Video (has a short sermon on the scripture read this Sunday, and announcements, following this text, but not verbatim) :

Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/orthodoxnet/videos/258226675554893/>

YouTube (improved video, with better sound): <https://youtu.be/H93jtFOd2-A>

English/**Thai**:

" Christ is risen!" / **"Pra - Chris - Song - Phun - Kun - Cheeb - Laow."**

"Truly, He is risen!" / **"Song - Phun - Kun - Cheeb, - Pen - Kwam - Jing."**

Audio (by a native Thai speaker): http://www.orthodox.net/music/pascha_2020+christ-is-risen-english-and-thai.mp3

Many of us are experiencing different levels of anxiety during this pandemic. It is not unchristian to feel some anxiety during this pandemic, or some disquiet in our soul, or feel overwhelmed. We are what are – sinful weak human beings. The way we react to our emotions, whether they are normal or even because of sin, determines if we are true Christians. A Christian must react to his emotions with prayer and with spiritual activity.

Some of you are very anxious to find out when regular services can be resumed. It goes without saying that soon as I know you will know. I have not contacted Archbishop Peter regarding any relaxation of his directives, because I think it's rather insulting to him that I would think that he would not inform me instantly if he decides to relax the directives. I assure you that Archbishop Peter's directives are not a static thing and that he is reevaluating them every day. He issued a letter recently. Since our local restrictions has not been lifted, at this time we are not changing anything, the changes will come soon.

Make sure that you are praying for our bishop. His burden is very heavy, and he is no doubt enduring much criticism and second-guessing.

This too will pass. My fear as a pastor is that our quarantine will pass and for some of you there will be no improvement in your spiritual life, or even a falling back. Human emotions are not necessarily sinful but they can definitely lead to sin. Watch that you don't drink too much or even at all, or watch too much TV or stream too many movies. Plug yourself into the community by praying during our services and watching them. Observe the days, especially Saturday and Sunday. Keep vigil at your home on Saturday, and observe the day on Sunday by praying the Typica service and eating after liturgy would be over. I've provided many prayers regarding the pandemic that I think

you should all be praying every day. For instance, I sent by email the entire text of the Typica service for St. Thomas Sunday. Did you pray this service?

This is a time to pray more. It is absolutely imperative that you pray on the weekends even more than you usually would. Obeying our government's and even our bishop's directives contain secular solutions. We live in society and we should be part of the secular solution, but if we are not leading the spiritual solution, we are squandering our opportunity and disobeying God.

We have a tradition that there are no prostrations in the church until the day of Pentecost. Regarding prostrations at home, they are at our discretion, in consultation with our spiritual father. During Bright week I did no prostrations, but when I pray the pandemic prayers starting next week, I will prostrate. It is been my practice to pray them on my knees in church, and if you want to do that at home, you have my blessing.

This Tuesday is Radonitsa. I will serve Vespers Monday night at 6 PM, and liturgy early in the morning on Tuesday at 8 AM. After liturgy, I will go down to Holy Nativity monastery in Texas and pray at the cemetery. This is the cemetery where my son +Daniel is buried, and many others whom I pray for. I will accept names for commemoration, only if they are printed neatly. I read Russian very poorly. I prefer very much that you send them to me electronically so I can assemble them into one document. It is very hard to shuffle papers, especially when standing outside in praying.

We are moving ahead on construction and renovation in the newly purchased church hall, and we are planning on expanding the church inside by breaking out the northern wall and moving it several feet, during this pandemic time. Please remember that our expenses are larger now, and even though all of us are feeling a financial pinch, we must remember our church.

I fully intend to continue collecting for the needs of our family with the sick child. His illness will be long-term. This treatment probably will last for three years. Please keep them in your prayers, and if you want to give any money that is targeted to helping them, please send a check or do a PayPal donation and designate what the funds are for. My hope is that our parish family will completely cover their medical deductible for this year. I'm not sure how much more we have to go, but it might be about \$6000.

Priest Seraphim

Service Schedule:

Date	Time	Service	Stream? Zoom? Links/Credentials
4/27	6pm	Vespers	Maybe. It will likely be rustic.
4/28	8am	Radonista. Divine Liturgy for the dead	youtube.com/orthodoxnet/live

4/28	About 1pm	Panikhida at the cemetery, Holy Nativity (women's) Monastery, Kemp TX	No streaming.
Thu	6pm	Moleben	Zoom. https://us02web.zoom.us/j/83185985881?pwd=cVZYS1pPdGh3M2VxNUR1ajFZYU
Sat	5pm	Vigil – 3 rd Sunday of Pascha	youtube.com/orthodoxnet/live
Sun	10am	Liturgy– 3 rd Sunday of Pascha	youtube.com/orthodoxnet/live

We will be rolling our phase two of the fundraising efforts for our new hall in the next week or two! Look forward to more information soon!

We do a Mitey Mites collection every week. There are more challenges now, since the church is closed to the public, but we are still collecting every week for the extreme needs that are becoming more pressing every day. This week, we are collecting for

(a) City Square, an excellent charitable organization for the poor and needy and Dallas that is working on the front lines of the current crisis.

We have set up a [PayPal link](#) which allows you to donate to our Mitey Mites Cause of the week. Any money collected through this link in the next 6 days will be applied to this week's collection.

If the link above doesn't work, you can enter this URL:

https://www.paypal.com/cgi-bin/webscr?cmd=_s-xclick&hosted_button_id=FHWE4PALUPG7U&source=url

Here are the relevant sites to check in a week or so when new info is available - Vladyka wants us to abide by the strictest of these:

<https://www.mckinneytexas.org/2256/Coronavirus-COVID-19>

<https://www.dshs.state.tx.us/coronavirus/>

<https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/index.html>

EVERYONE should ask Fr David Straut to add them to his email list. He sends complete services weekly, or sometimes more often. Highly recommended and **COMMANDED**! You must ask him to send you an invitation. Send an email to Fr David Straut <FrDavidStraut@protonmail.com> . Ask him to send an invitation to be on the Vigil Texts Group.

I will be sending the Typica service for next week. It will always use this service (below), and also a small file of the variable parts for that day. Get this service, and print it off.

<http://www.orthodox.net/services/typica.html>

<http://www.orthodox.net/services/typica.pdf>

<http://www.orthodox.net/services/typica.doc>